

Afifah Kashif

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Research interests: AI evaluation [2–4,6,10], human-AI and human-robot interaction [1,5,7,9], and AI governance [3,7–9]

EDUCATION

University of Cambridge Cambridge, UK
M.Phil. Human-Inspired Artificial Intelligence (with Distinction) Oct 2025 – Jun 2026
Dissertation: Bias by Whose Definition? The Construct Validity of Dictionary-Based and LLM-as-Judge Bias Evaluation in Conversational AI (Supervisors: Dr. Jin Huang, Dr. Malak Sadek, Dr. Hatice Gunes)
University of Washington, Paul G. Allen School of Computer Science & Engineering Seattle, USA
B.S. Computer Science, Minor in Law, Societies & Justice Sep 2022 – Jun 2025
Study Abroad: Rome, Italy (Jan – Mar 2024), Honors: *The Global Refugee Crisis: From Devastation to Diaspora*
GPA: 3.77/4.00, Dean's List, Completed one year early
Capstone: Ointment Care Robot for Limited Mobility Users (Instructor: Dr. Maya Cakmak)
Bellevue College Bellevue, USA
A.A. Arts and Sciences; A.S. Engineering, Physics and Atmospheric Sciences Sep 2020 – Jun 2022
Earned concurrently with high school through dual credit; GPA: 3.98/4.00, Dean's List

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Visiting Researcher, Stanford University Sep 2026 – Present
Prof. Julian Nyarko, Dr. Megan Ma (Legal Innovation through Frontier Technology Lab, Stanford Law School)
Research Assistant, University of Cambridge Jul 2026 – Present
Dr. Katie Seaborn (Aspire Lab, Department of Computer Science and Technology), Dr. Malak Sadek (HIVE Lab, Centre for Human Inspired AI)
Researcher, PluralisticAI Lab Mar 2026 – Present
Dr. Zhenzhen Qi (University of Connecticut), Dr. Avijit Ghosh (Hugging Face)
CORDA Democracy Fellow, Odyssean Institute Apr 2026 – Sep 2026
Jacob Haimes (Apart Research), Dr. Swaptik Chowdhury (RAND)
Research Assistant, University of Washington Sep 2024 – Jun 2025
Dr. Amy Ko (Wordplay Project, UW Information School)

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Robotics Software Engineering Intern, Hello Robot May 2025 – Aug 2025
Human-Robot Interaction and UX focus (Dr. Vinitha Ranganeni)
Backend Software Engineering Intern, HowellCo Jul 2024 – Sep 2024
Software Engineering Intern, Code.org Jul 2023 – Sep 2023
Operations and Product Intern, Fiveable Apr 2021 – Nov 2021

PUBLICATIONS

[1] **Designing Power Systems as a Social Interface for Assistive Robots**
Afifah Kashif, Vy Nguyen, Vinitha Ranganeni
ACM/IEEE International Conference on Human-Robot Interaction (HRI) 2027. [Under Review]
[2] **Do Language and Visual Perturbations Compound? Interaction Effects and Backend Sensitivity in Compact Vision-Language-Action Model Evaluation**
Abdul Muhsin Hameed, Afifah Kashif, Asim Iqbal
International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR) 2027. [Under Review]
[3] **Synthetic Dataset Creation as Governance Infrastructure for Embodied AI Bias Evaluation**
Afifah Kashif
UK AI Research Symposium (UKAIRS) 2026, Emerging Research Track. [Peer-Reviewed, Accepted]

[4] Vision-Language-Action Models Need Neuroscience’s Evaluation Toolkit, Not Just Its Architectures

Abdul Muhsin Hameed, **Afifah Kashif**, Asim Iqbal

Workshop on Grounded and Faithful Vision-Language Models for Real-World Deployment (VLM4RWD) @ NeurIPS 2026. [Under Review]

[5] Beyond the Monolithic Interface: A Research Agenda for Plural Conversational AI

Avijit Ghosh, **Afifah Kashif**, Isabelle Kohout, Zhenzhen Qi

Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (Nature Portfolio). [Under Review]

[6] Mapping Collective Imaginaries of AI Risk: Expert Elicitation, Causal Modeling and LLM-Assisted Coding

Anshikha Kumar, **Afifah Kashif**, Jacob Haimés, Swaptik Chowdhury

AI4GOOD Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026. [Under Review]

[7] Governance as Methodology: Toward Anticipatory, Design-Embedded Governance for Human-Robot Interaction

Afifah Kashif, Malak Sadek

2nd Interactive AI for Human-Centered Robotics Workshop @ ACM/IEEE HRI 2026. [Peer-Reviewed; Presented]

[8] Governance at the Edge of Architecture: Regulating NeuroAI and Neuromorphic Systems

Afifah Kashif, Abdul Hameed, Asim Iqbal

arXiv:2602.01503, 2026. [Preprint]

[9] Regulatory Considerations for Physically Assistive Robotics Researchers

Afifah Kashif, Amal Nanavati, Maya Cakmak

Physical Caregiving Robots Workshop @ ACM/IEEE HRI 2025. [Peer-Reviewed; Presented]

[10] Assessing GPT’s Bias Towards Stigmatized Social Groups: An Intersectional Case Study on Nationality Prejudice and Psychophobia

Afifah Kashif*, Heer Patel*

*Equal contribution

Considering Cultural and Linguistic Diversity in AI Applications Workshop @ ASIS&T 2024. [Peer-Reviewed; Presented]

Other Writing

The Hidden Social Costs of AI

EvalEval Coalition. Blog Post. November 2025.

HONORS AND AWARDS

Winner, Hack the Law Research Pitch (2026): Stanford x Cambridge competition for funded research placement.

Top 5 Nominee, Academic Representative of the Year (2026): Cambridge Excellence Awards.

Marcy Migdal Fellowship (2025): UW Center for Global Studies; funded a digital literacy program for recently resettled refugee women.

Nordic Scholars Leadership Institute (2025): Inaugural cohort, Stockholm, Sweden.

Distinguished Leader Award (2023): Harvard WECODE.

TALKS

Panelist, “Intergenerational Perspectives on AI in a Changing World”	Jun 2026
<i>Centre for Human-Inspired AI, Annual Conference, University of Cambridge Union</i>	

Dissertation Seminar, “Bias by Whose Definition?”	May 2026
<i>Centre for Human-Inspired AI, University of Cambridge</i>	

Speaker, CHIA Early Career Community Event	May 2026
<i>Centre for Human-Inspired AI, University of Cambridge</i>	

Guest Lecture, “An Ethical AI Lens for Neuroinclusive Design”	Feb 2026
<i>Inclusive Design Futures (Dr. Matteo Zallio), University of Cambridge</i>	

Speaker, “The Politics of Educational Technology”	Feb 2026
<i>Clareity x Whiston Series, Clare College 700th Anniversary, University of Cambridge</i>	

TEACHING

Supervisor, Computer Science and Human-Computer Interaction <i>University of Cambridge</i>	Oct 2025 – Mar 2026 <i>Cambridge, UK</i>
Founder and Instructor, Digital Literacy Program <i>International Rescue Committee and Kabul Seattle Community Services</i>	Jan 2025 – Present <i>Seattle, WA</i>
Teaching Assistant, Intro Programming and The Hardware/Software Interface <i>University of Washington</i>	Jan 2023 – Mar 2025 <i>Seattle, WA</i>
Section Leader, Code in Place <i>Stanford University</i>	Apr 2024 – May 2024 <i>Remote</i>
Language and Literacy Teacher <i>CPIA1 Roma</i>	Jan 2024 – Mar 2024 <i>Rome, Italy</i>

SERVICE

Program Committee: UserSim: Grounded User Simulation Workshop @ NeurIPS 2026	
Workshop Host: CMD-IT/ACM Richard Tapia Conference 2024 (first and only undergraduate team)	
Event Organizer: Shared Futures Foundation Buildathon, London, 2026; Techtogether Hackathon, Seattle, 2026	
Member: EvalEval Coalition	2025 – Present
AI Research Events Lead: Cambridge AI Research Society	2026 – Present
Academic Representative: Cambridge Institute of Technology and Humanity	2025 – Present
Executive Officer: Paul G. Allen School Student Advisory Council, University of Washington	2022 – 2024
Co-Founder and Vice President: Women in Law Society, University of Washington	2023 – 2025

LANGUAGES

English (native), Urdu/Hindi (native)